

Soon, Atalanta's name was known all over Greece. When her father discovered that she was alive, he was filled with guilt. Iasos looked for Atalanta so he could apologize for rejecting her as a baby. "Dearest daughter, can you ever forgive me?" he asked her. "Please return to Arcadia with me." Never having known a family before, Atalanta agreed.

When they arrived, she discovered that as a princess she was expected to marry and form an alliance to help her father's kingdom. Atalanta had traveled the world and achieved so much though, and she would only marry someone worthy of her. "I won't let you marry me off just for wealth and power," she told her father. "To prove themselves, my suitors will have to beat me at a trial."

*Crowds came to cheer on the runners.*



Atalanta decided that any man who wished to marry her had to demonstrate that he was as fast, if not faster, than she was, by challenging each of them in turn to a race. Those who were arrogant enough to go up against her but could not outrun her on the track would sacrifice their life.